

Sara AHARON

Territorial Planning Student – GIS ✧ Remote Sensing ✧ Environmental Research

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PROFILE

Territorial Planning student specializing in GIS-based spatial analysis and remote sensing applications. Experienced with QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Sentinel-2 and Landsat imagery, and geospatial datasets for monitoring urban expansion, vegetation dynamics, and coastal change. Research experience includes multi-temporal environmental analysis and GIS modeling, supported by NASA and ESRI training.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's degree

Oct 2024 – Present • Iași, Romania • Alexandru Ioan Cuza of Iași, Faculty of Geography and Geology

- ✧ Specialization in Territorial Planning
- ✧ Recipient of Merit Scholarship for academic excellence, 2024–2025 and 2025–2026
- ✧ 1st Prize – Top First-Year Student in Territorial Planning specialization, 2024/2025

Academia RATIO XVI Summer School

Aug 2026 • Cluj, Romania • Babeș-Bolyai University, Faculty of Economic Sciences

Erasmus+ Blended Intensive Programme - Safe mountain explorer

June 2026 • Wrocław, Poland • Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences

European Economic Studies

Oct 2013 – June 2014 • Bucharest, Romania • Romanian-American University

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager | Dead Freddie's Restaurant & Bar

Apr 2014 – Jan 2024 • Ocean City, Maryland, USA

- ✧ Directed daily operations and led a multinational team at a high-volume hospitality venue, building strong leadership and problem-solving skills

RESEARCH

Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand

Jun 2026 • Bucharest, Romania

- ✧ Conducted multi-temporal shoreline change analysis on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand (2004–2024) using Landsat and Sentinel-2 imagery processed in Google Earth Engine, QGIS and ArcGIS
- ✧ Integrated remote sensing outputs with GIS-based transect analysis to assess spatial patterns of erosion and accretion across key coastal sectors
- ✧ Examined the intersection of coastal geomorphology and tourism pressure in a high-footfall island destination, with implications for sustainable coastal management

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure - Focșani Municipality (1990–2025)

Nov 2025 • Iași, Romania • 2nd Place, Mihai David National Student Symposium (CERNESIM, UAIC)

- ✧ Elaborated a 35-year multi-temporal geospatial analysis of urban expansion patterns and green infrastructure loss across Focșani Municipality
- ✧ Findings revealed a measurable inverse relationship between built-up density and urban green cover over the study period, with implications for sustainable urban planning policy
- ✧ Presented research at national symposium level, receiving 2nd place recognition

✧ Also presented at: geo-spatial.org Seminars Ed. 45 (Chișinău, Moldova, Mar 2026) • Simpozionul Internațional de SIG și Teledetecție (UAIC, Mar 2026) • Simpozionul Național al Studenților Geografi, Ed. XXXII (Bucharest, Mar 2026) • Conferința Națională "George Vâlsan" (UBB Cluj, May 2026) • Sesiunea Anuală de Comunicări Științifice (Univ. Craiova, May 2026)

CONFERENCES & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- ✧ **Presenter**, MDPI, The 6th International Electronic Conference on Remote Sensing, Basel, Switzerland, 20 Oct 2026
- ✧ **Poster Presenter**, ASI-CEOS WGD International Workshop on “Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management”, Italian Space Agency (ASI), Rome, Italy, 16 Sep 2026
- ✧ Participant, JUST4MPA Hands-on Conference Blue Justice and Social Equity for Marine Protected Areas, University of Bucharest, Romania, 8-9 Jun 2026
- ✧ Participant, Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop, organized in collaboration with the Italian, German, and Romanian space agencies, National University of Science and Technology POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Romania, 28 Apr 2026
- ✧ Participant, Climate Change Summit 2025, Palace of Parliament, Bucharest, Romania, 21 Oct 2025

PROJECTS

Just and Resilient Communities - International Field Research

May 2026 • Piatra Neamț, Romania • Van Hall Larenstein University, NL / ADR Nord-Est / UAIC

- ✧ Contributed to field research on community livelihoods in Alexandru cel Bun, supporting the development of actionable recommendations for local authorities

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate - Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide

Sept 2025 • Bucharest, Romania • Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity (GOV)

- ✧ Collaborated with student delegates from across Romania and the diaspora to develop consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration

V.O.T.C.A. – Vreau o Țară ca Afară

Sept 2025 • Vatra Dornei, Romania • Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity (GOV)

- ✧ Participated in the production of a documentary film (Vreau O Țară Ca Afară, 2025) capturing environmental findings and community impact from field operations across mountain areas of Romania

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide

Aug 2024 • Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania • Department for Romanians Everywhere (GOV)

- ✧ Guided and mentored 50 young members of the Romanian diaspora from Ukraine and the Republic of Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program, supporting their reconnection with Romanian language, heritage, and identity

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Technical: GIS (QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine) ✧ Remote Sensing (Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST) ✧ Data Analysis ✧ Programming (VS Code, SQL, Python) ✧ Web Development (HTML, CSS, WordPress, GitHub Pages)

Soft Skills: Research ✧ Analysis ✧ Problem Solving ✧ Attention to Detail ✧ Leadership ✧ Teamwork ✧ Time Management

Languages: Romanian (native) ✧ English (fluent) ✧ Spanish (intermediate) ✧ German (beginner)

GIS, Remote Sensing & Cartography

- ✧ GIS for Climate Action – ESRI (Mar 2026)
- ✧ Going Places with Spatial Analysis – ESRI (Feb 2026)
- ✧ GIS Basics – ESRI (Feb 2026)
- ✧ The ArcGIS Imagery MOOC: Foundations and Frontiers – ESRI (Nov 2025)
- ✧ Fundamentals of Remote Sensing – NASA (Nov 2025)
- ✧ Cartography – ESRI (Oct 2025)
- ✧ Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps – ESRI (May 2025)

Climate, Conservation & Nature

- ✧ Synthetic Biology in relation to Nature Conservation – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Mapping Biodiversity Priorities – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Finance for Nature – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Conservation and Agriculture – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Cities and Nature – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Conservation and Climate Change – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ United for Nature and Society – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Nature's Crown Jewels: An Introduction to Nature World Heritage – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Community Forestry 101 – RECOFTC (July 2026)
- ✧ Circular Economy – HP Foundation (May 2025)

Data, AI & Open Science

- ✧ The Rise of GeoAI – Esri on AWS – AWS (Feb 2026)
- ✧ NASA Open Science 101 – NASA (Feb 2026)
- ✧ NASA Open Science Essentials – NASA (Feb 2026)
- ✧ Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence – AWS (Jan 2026)
- ✧ Intro to Generative AI – Google Cloud Training Online (Jan 2026)
- ✧ Data Science & Analytics – HP Foundation (May 2025)

Other

- ✧ A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot – EASA (valid to Dec 2030)
- ✧ ECDL Romania - ICDL Certification (Jan 2010)